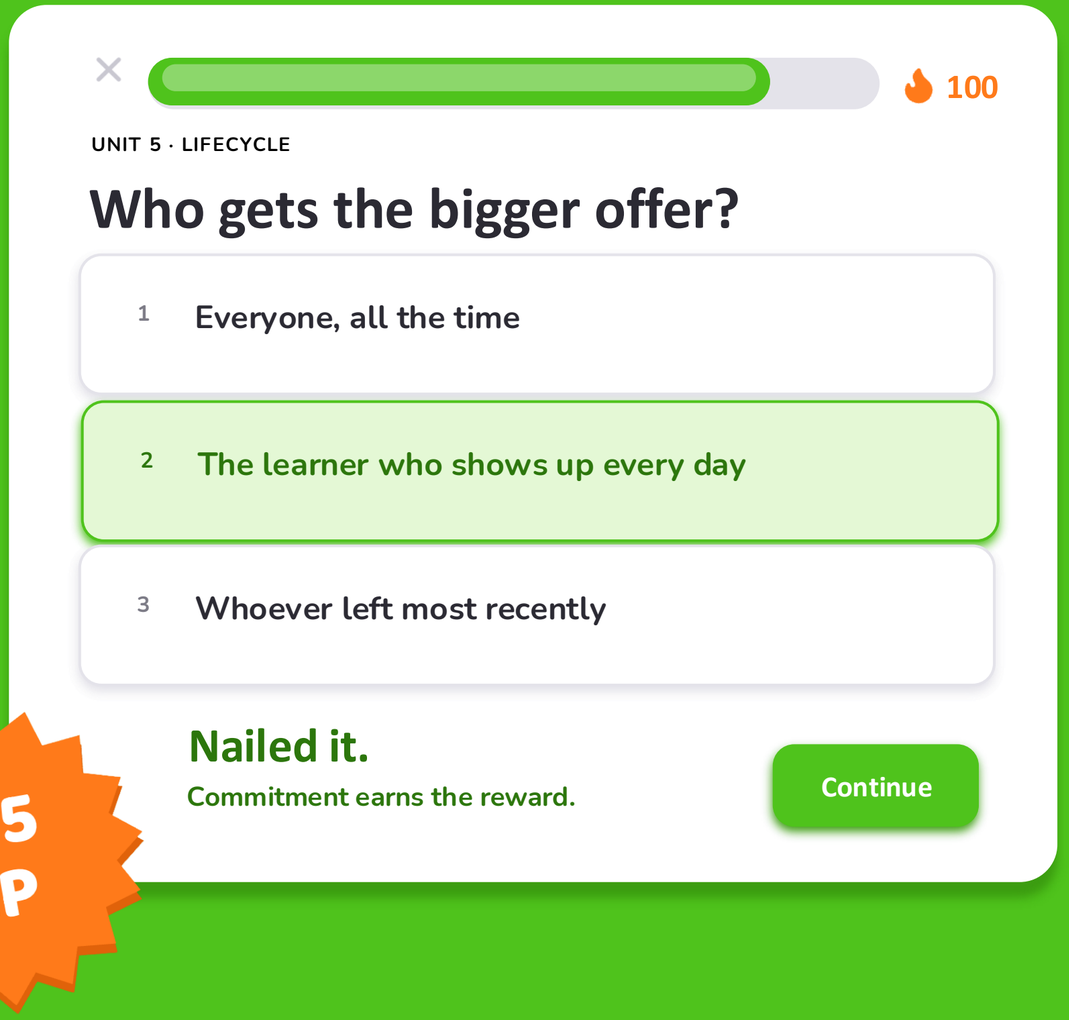
DUOLINGO LIFECYCLE PLAN · USA

Reward Commitment, Respect Goodbyes

A lifecycle plan that spends more on the learners who've already made Duolingo a habit.

CINDY HA AI IN MARKETING· ASSIGNMENT 5



duolingo

A. RFM SEGMENTATION

We score every learner on how recently, how often and how much they commit

R Recency

Days since last learning session

3	0–7 days (one league week)
2	8–30 days
1	31+ days (drops out of monthly actives)

Session = any XP-earning lesson, practice, story or Video Call. Energy refills, gifts, feed likes and streak freezes don't count.

F Frequency

Share of days practiced, 12 months or since signup

3	75%+ (about 5+ days a week)
2	25–74%
1	Under 25%

Not scored: accounts 30 days old or less are Bronze Beginners. 12+ months silent = Suppressed.

M Monetary

Plan held

3	Super Individual, Super Family manager, legacy Max
2	Super Lite, Family member, or a paid English Test
1	Free, including free trials

M uses the current plan for active learners and the plan at their last session for lapsed ones.

Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, Oct 10, 2026.

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A. RFM SEGMENTATION

Fewer than 8% of our learners bring in 57% of bookings

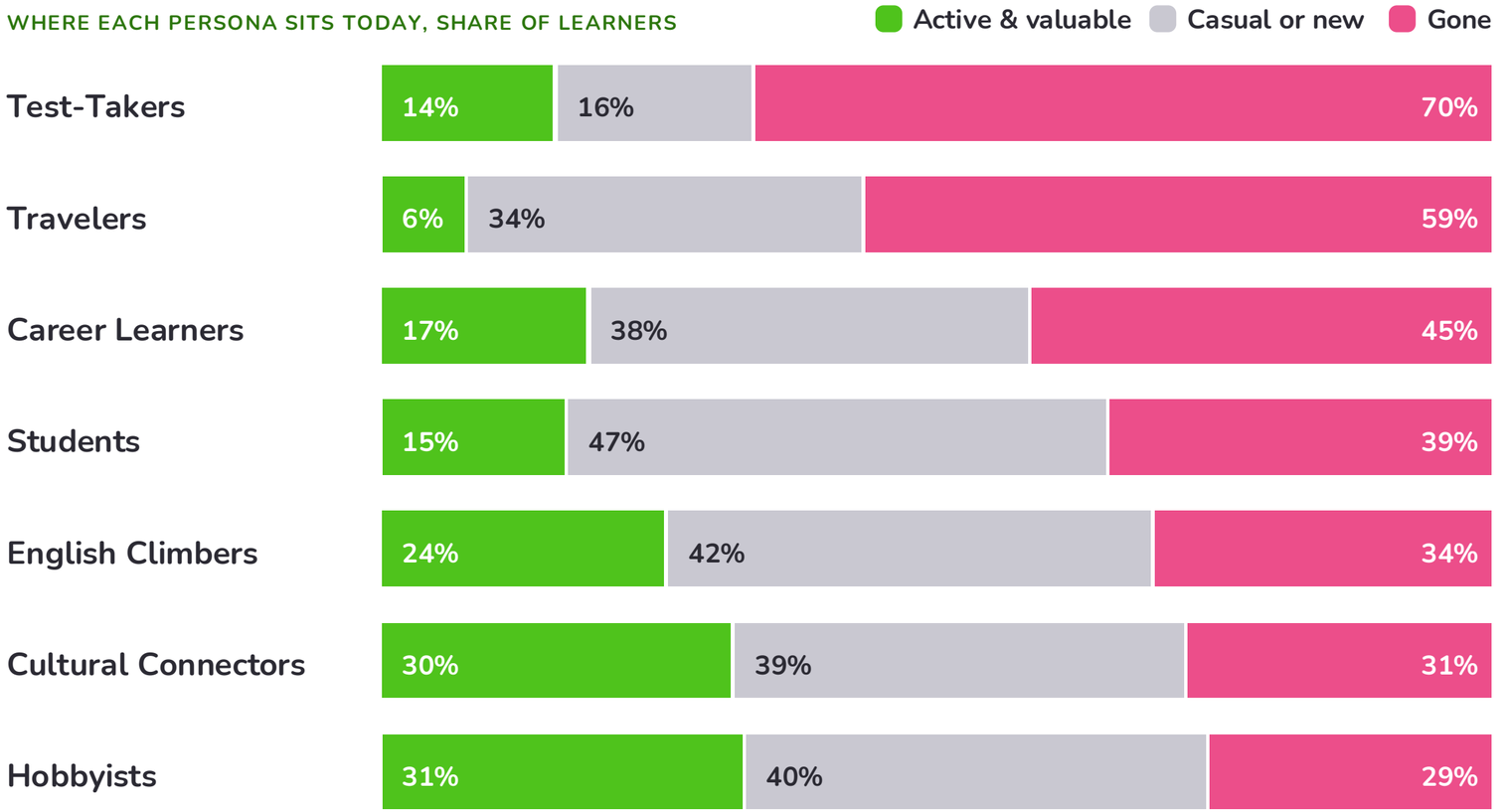
RANK	TIER	RFM	WHO THEY ARE	% OF LEARNERS	% OF 12-MO BOOKINGS
1	Diamond Devotees	3-3-3	Near-daily, full-price subscriber	2.8%	26.4%
2	Pearl Pros	3-(2/3)-(2/3)	Paying, practicing steadily	4.8%	30.5%
3	Ebbing Emeralds	paid, R2 or F1	Still paying, practicing less	0.9%	5.5%
4	Ruby Regulars	3-3-1	Near-daily, free	12.4%	4.6%
5	Sleeping Sapphires	1-any-(2/3)	Paid, gone 31+ days	1.7%	9.6%
6	Gold Grazers	free, R3 F1–2 or R2	Free, learns now and then	32.9%	15.6%
7	Silent Silvers	1-any-1	Free, gone 31+ days	25.0%	1.1%
Entry	Bronze Beginners	account ≤30 days	New, value still unknown	7.3%	2.7%
Out	Suppressed	no learning 12+ mo	No paid win-back	12.1%	4.0%

Tiers are named after Duolingo's leagues: a higher league = a more valuable learner. Names are internal only. Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, Oct 10, 2026.

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A. RFM SEGMENTATION

Goals decide the goodbye: travelers and test-takers leave when they arrive, hobbyists stay



13%

of cancellers say, “reached my goal.”

SO WHAT

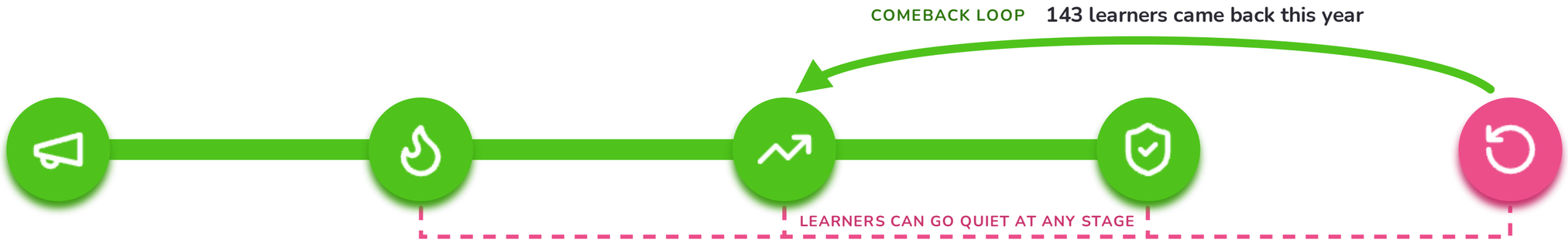
Time win-backs to the next goal: the semester, the trip, the retake.

Gone = 31+ days quiet or Suppressed (12+ months). Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated). Personas are a content overlay on the RFM tiers.

duolingo

B. LIFECYCLE JOURNEY

The first week decides the next: learners who practice 6 of their first 7 days are 5x as likely to still be learning



Acquire

DAY 0

Meets Duo online or at events

Win learners who will stick

12x

return per $ on friend referrals, vs 2x on paid social

Not scored yet

Onboard

DAYS 1–30

Picks a goal, starts a streak

A 7-day streak in week one

80%

still learning after a strong first week, vs 16% after a weak one

Bronze Beginners

Grow

MONTH 2+

Learns daily, hits free limits

Turn daily free learners into payers

619

Ruby Regulars learn 88% of days but don't pay

Ruby Regulars

Gold Grazers

Retain

PAYING

Pays and renews each year

Protect streaks and renewals

62%

of bookings come from 9% of learners

Diamond Devotees

Pearl Pros

Ebbing Emeralds

Win Back

31+ DAYS QUIET

Reaches a goal or drifts off

Win back only who's worth it

6%

of win-back messages bring a learner back

Sleeping Sapphires

Silent Silvers

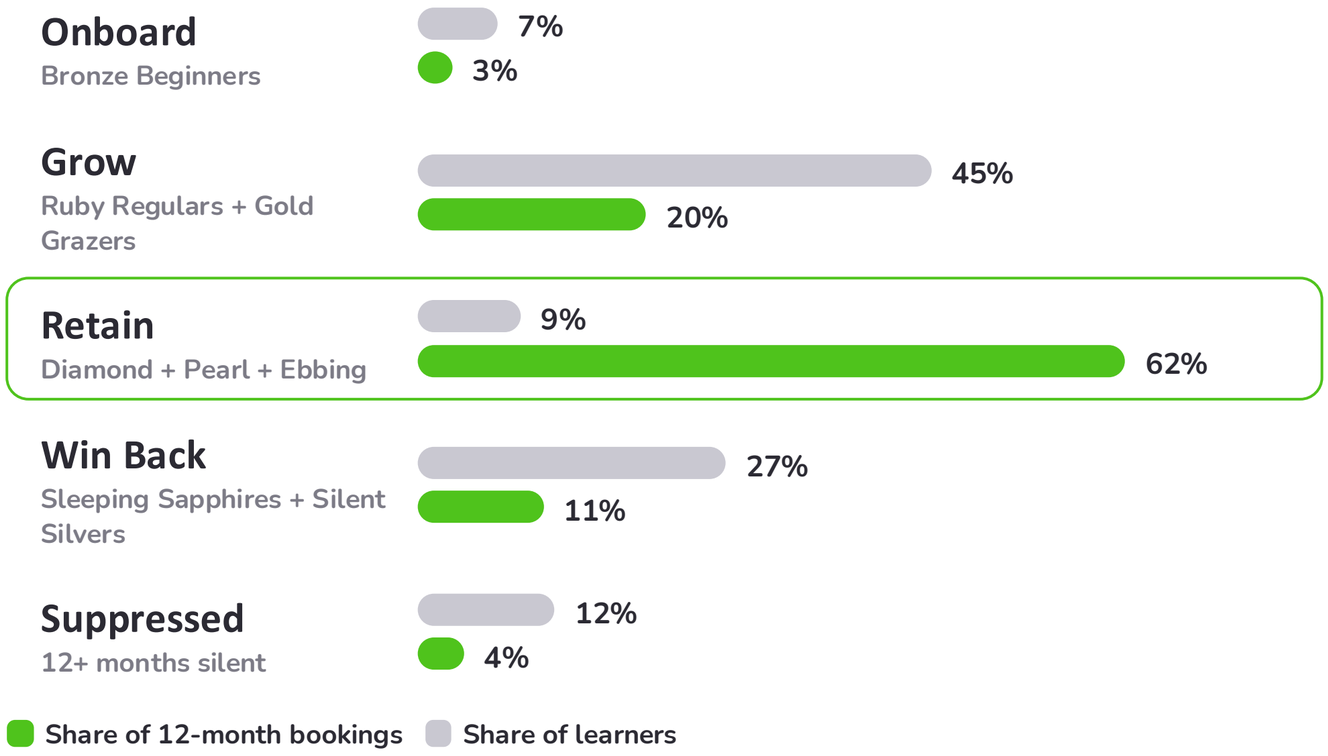
Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, snapshot Oct 10, 2026. Tier names are internal only.

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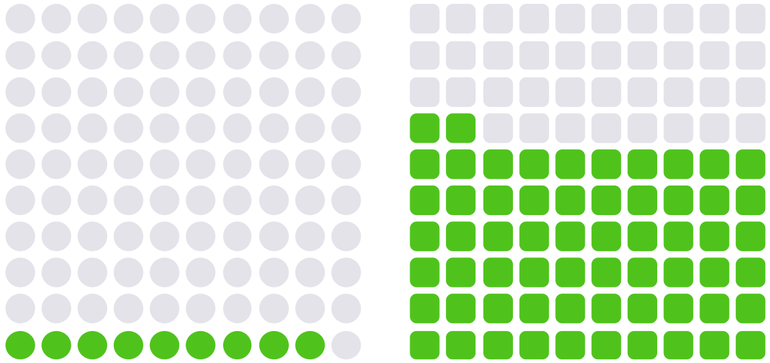
B. LIFECYCLE JOURNEY

Retain holds the cash, Grow has the space for opportunity

SHARE OF LEARNERS VS SHARE OF 12-MONTH BOOKINGS



RETAIN, OUT OF EVERY 100



9 learners

$62 in bookings

GROW HAS THE SPACE

45% of learners, 20% of bookings. Part C converts its 619 Ruby Regulars.

Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, snapshot Oct 10, 2026.

duolingo

C. TRIGGERED TACTICS

One segment, five moments: we turn daily free learners into subscribers, then keep them

	Acquire free → Super	Onboard trial	Grow paid	Retain renewal	Win back 31+ days quiet
TRIGGER	Streak hits 50, 100 or 365 days, or 3rd time out of Energy in 7 days (max 1 email per 30 days)	2 days before the trial ends	30 days after converting, all subscribers	30 days before first renewal	31+ days with no lesson, timed to the next goal; stop after 12 months
GOAL	Start a Super trial within 7 days	Trial converts to paid	Upgrade to Super Family within 14 days	Renew	One lesson within 7 days
SUBJECT LINE	EMAIL 1 it's our 100 days! time flies with you.	EMAIL 2 you have 3 missed calls from Lily, call her back on Super?	EMAIL 3 family isn't always blood, sometimes it's duolingo streaks	EMAIL 4 your year of Super, in numbers	HIGH VALUE shhh, you're our favorite so here's your streak back. don't tell the others STANDARD 1 lesson, 5 minutes. but we think you can be even faster

VALUE BANDS, 619 RUBY REGULARS



- **High value** 223 (36%) — 100+ day streak or a former payer
- **Tried a trial** 77 (12%) — Trial before, didn't convert
- **Standard** 319 (52%) — Everyone else

Source: Duolingo US digital twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, Oct 10, 2026.

duolingo

C. TRIGGERED TACTICS

We celebrate the habit first, then make the upgrade feel earned

duolingo

100-DAY ANNIVERSARY

100



DAYS OF CHINESE, TOGETHER

you've outgrown the free plan (they grow up so fast)

100 days of Chinese, Zuzu. That's more commitment than most people give their situationships. You also ran out of Energy three times this week, which means you're ready for more.

To celebrate, Super is on us for 14 days: unlimited Energy, no ads, and Video Call with Lily.

YOUR ANNIVERSARY GIFT

14 days of Super, free

Then $83.99 for your first year (30% off $119.99).

Start my free trial

Cancel anytime before day 14 and you won't be charged. We'll remind you 2 days before.

1 · ACQUIRE

SUBJECT

it's our 100 days! time flies with you.

TRIGGER

Streak milestone or 3rd time out of Energy in 7 days

GOAL

Super trial within 7 days

OFFER BY BAND

High value
14-day trial + 30% off ($83.99)

Tried a trial
20% off ($95.99)

Standard
7-day trial, full price

duolingo

SUPER TRIAL

new voicemail from Lily

Voicemail 0:14



Lily

3 missed calls

“nǐ hǎo, it's lily. again. you have super for 2 more days and you still haven't called. i'm not upset. (i'm a little upset.)”

Call her back

On Oct 23, Super continues at $83.99 for your first year. Want to stop? Cancel in Settings before then and you won't be charged.

2 · ONBOARD

SUBJECT

you have 3 missed calls from Lily, call her back on Super?

TRIGGER

2 days before the trial ends

GOAL

Trial converts to paid

OFFER BY BAND

High value
Keeps $83.99

Standard
$119.99

Honest price and cancel line for everyone.

Concept emails, desktop layout, cropped above the footer. Example values shown; production uses learner fields. All prices US.

duolingo

C. TRIGGERED TACTICS

Paying learners get more reasons to share, not more discounts

3 · GROW 30 days after converting · Family within 14 days

duolingo SUPER FAMILY

family isn't always blood, sometimes it's duolingo streaks

you open open open open open

Your plan could have 5 more seats, and right now they're empty. Fill them with your study buddy, your siblings, or your partner who keeps asking how to curse in Chinese (sorry, we don't teach that).

SUPER FAMILY
$119.99 for up to 6 people
Your first year (regularly $143.99). We'll credit what's left on your current plan.

Fill my seats

High value: Family $119.99 first year ($24 off) · others: $143.99

4 · RETAIN 30 days before first renewal · Renew

duolingo YEAR IN REVIEW

your year of super, in numbers

312 days practiced

41,850 XP earned

2,140 words learned

Super renews on Nov 9 at $119.99 a year (your first year was $83.99). Your streak, XP and calls with Lily stay exactly as they are.

Share my year Keep Super

Everyone: no discount. Share my year opens the story set.

YEAR IN REVIEW STORY



Card 3: the language leads, Duo reacts.

Concept emails (cropped above the footer) and story. Example values shown. All prices US.

duolingo

C. TRIGGERED TACTICS

Same stage, different treatment: a proven learner gets their streak and 40% off, a casual one gets a nudge

5A · HIGH VALUE · 2 SENDS

shhh, you're our favorite so here's your streak back. don't tell the others

duolingo

JUST BETWEEN US

214

DAY STREAK · RESTORED



your 214-day streak is back (just between us)

Life got busy. That happens, even to owls. A 214-day streak is too good to lose over one quiet month, so we restored it. Do one lesson this week to keep it.

Your trip to Shanghai is 3 weeks out. Perfect timing.

WELCOME BACK

40% off a year of Super

$71.99 instead of $119.99. Ends Nov 17.

Do one lesson

5B · STANDARD · 1 SEND

1 lesson, 5 minutes. but we think you can be even faster

duolingo

STREAK REPAIR



got 5 minutes? (we bet you only need 4.)

One Chinese lesson takes about 5 minutes. Do one today and we'll repair your streak so you pick up right where you left off.

Classes start Monday. Warm up now.

Do one lesson

SIDE BY SIDE

what each learner gets, and what it costs us

	HIGH VALUE (5A)	STANDARD (5B)
Who	100+ day streak before lapsing, or a former payer	Short streak, never paid
Emails	2	1
Offer	Streak restored + up to 40% off ($71.99)	Streak repair only
Cost per send	up to $48 if redeemed	about $0.05
Return rate	~22%	~4.7%
Cost per learner won back	~$12	~$1
Worth of a returner	High: likely to subscribe again (~$191 lifetime)	Low: no sign they'll pay

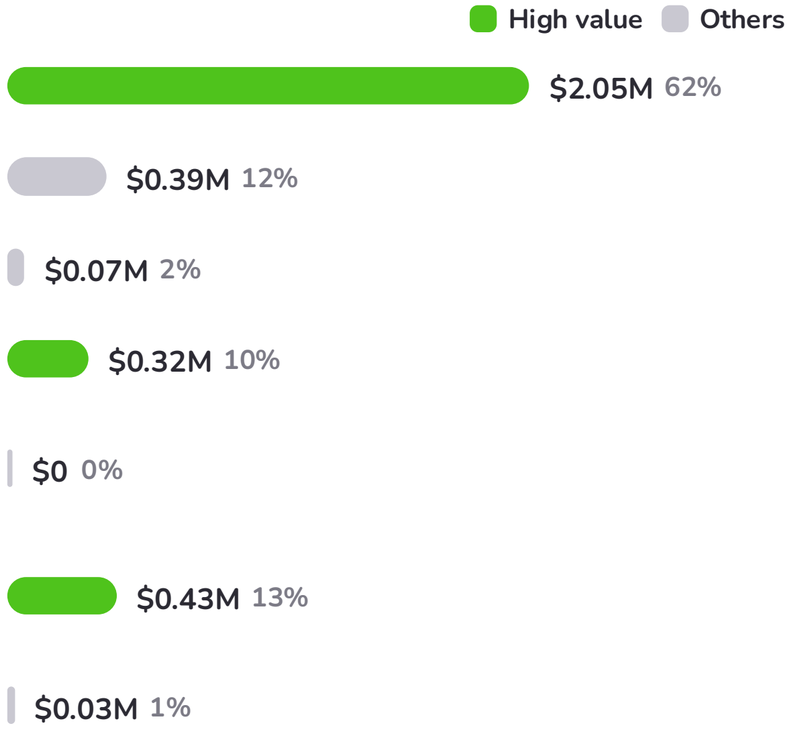
Stacking rule: one discount at a time, max $72 per learner per 12 months; offers step down 40% → 30% → streak repair after recent discounts. Return rates simulated.

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C. TRIGGERED TACTICS

85% of the budget goes to the third of learners most likely to stay

QUARTERLY INCENTIVE SPEND, US



Total per quarter **$3.30M**

$3.30M
planned per quarter (of $4.73M approved)

3.2x
year-one return

~426K
US subscribers a year

WE TESTED THE DISCOUNT — 30,000 high-value learners, seed 1010

ARM	SUBSCRIBED	2-YR VALUE	$ / EXTRA SUB
No offer	3.6%	$6.29	n/a
Trial + 30% off	12.8%	$18.01	$54
Trial + 40% off	14.5%	$18.09	$67

About a quarter of offer-arm subscribers would have subscribed anyway.

40% wins more subscribers but no more value (+$0.10, not significant). We chose 30%.

Sources: Duolingo Q2 2026 shareholder letter; Duolingo US digital twin and discount test (simulated).

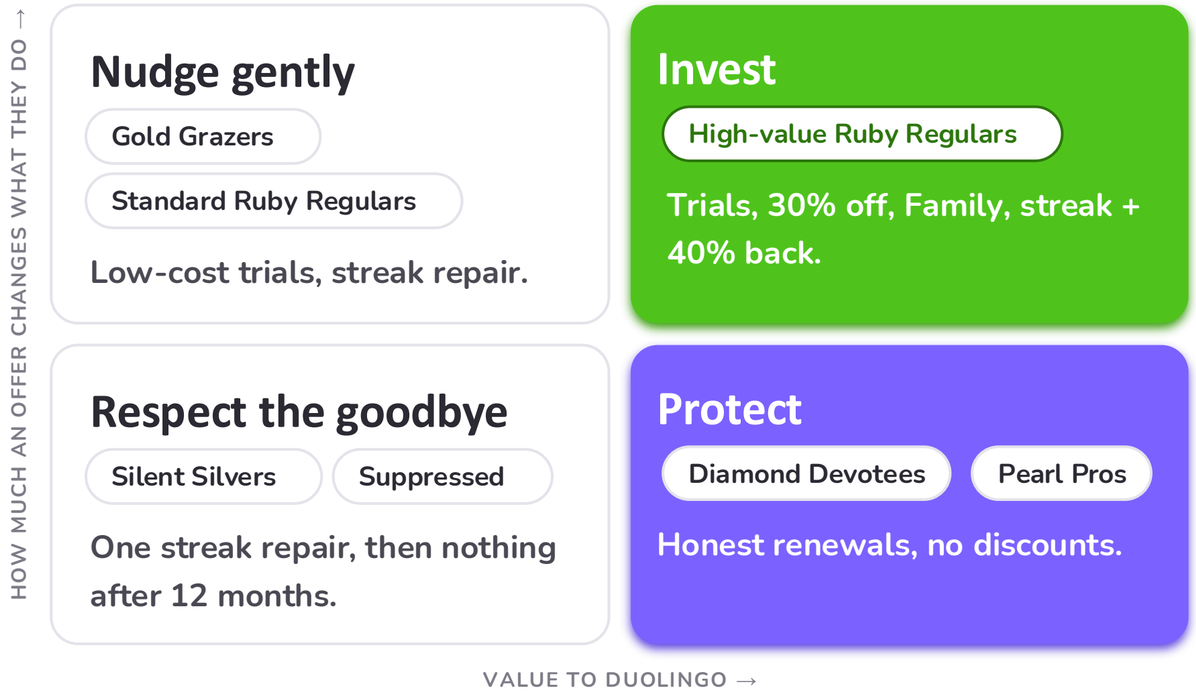
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D. POINT OF VIEW

Reward commitment, respect goodbyes

We invest most in learners who have already made Duolingo part of their day: Ruby Regulars with a 100+ day streak or a past subscription.

They're about a third of the segment and receive 85% of our incentive budget, because a commitment that strong has earned a reason to go further, and they're the learners most likely to stay. Our current subscribers (9% of learners, 62% of bookings) get honesty instead of discounts: a clear renewal date and a year worth celebrating. Learners who drift away get one free streak repair, timed to their next goal. Many have reached what they came for, so if they stay quiet past 12 months, we respect that and stop sending offers.



Source: Duolingo US digital twin and discount test (simulated). Tier names are internal only.

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APPENDIX

The plan is built for the US; plans and prices change by country

PLAN	WHAT IT IS (FALL 2026)
Free	Ads, and a mobile Energy limit.
Super Lite	Cheaper plan with some ads. A test; availability depends on geography.
Super Individual	Unlimited Energy, no ads, Video Call moving in from Max.
Super Family	A manager plus up to 5 members.
Max (legacy)	Being sunset for new subscribers; its AI features move into Super.
Duolingo English Test	$70, same price worldwide before tax. Fee waivers through the Access Program.

US REFERENCE PRICES (IOS)

Super	$119.99/yr or $16.99/mo
Family	$143.99/yr
Lite (test)	$35.99/yr
Legacy Max	$167.99/yr or $29.99/mo

WHAT CHANGES OUTSIDE THE US

M scores map to each market's plans. Offers are set as percentages, not dollars. Copy, jokes, dates and offers are written natively per market with a native-speaker check. Over half of Duolingo's bookings come from outside the US.

Prices vary by country, platform, billing currency and tax. Verify local plan availability and prices before using in market.

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APPENDIX

References and AI disclosure

DUOLINGO FILINGS AND SOURCES

- Duolingo Q2 2026 Shareholder Letter (SEC 8-K)
- Duolingo 2025 Annual Report (SEC)
- 2024 Duolingo Language Report
- English learner motivations by generation (Duolingo blog)
- Never too late to learn (Duolingo blog)
- Understudied language motivations (Duolingo blog, 2021)
- How language learning differs between generations (Duolingo blog)
- How is the Duolingo English Test scored (DET blog)
- Duolingo Access Program (DET blog)

NEWS AND ANALYSIS

- Subscription Insider: Duolingo's Q2 paid subscriber growth
- Motley Fool: The Green Owl Is Ending Duolingo's Own Cash Cow (Sept 14, 2026)
- Yahoo Finance: Duolingo AI and New Subjects in 2026 (May 6, 2026)

PRICING, PRODUCT AND COURSE

- Language App Guide: How Much Does Duolingo Cost in 2026
- Cialfo: Complete Guide to the Duolingo English Test 2026
- Cialfo: DET vouchers guide
- GradRight: Understanding Your Duolingo Score Results
- Brainbound: Duolingo charges guide
- Deconstructor of Fun: Duolingo leagues
- Assignment 5 brief; Week 5 lecture, CRM and Lifecycle (Prof. Chris Ribeiro)

AI DISCLOSURE Claude (Anthropic) Model Opus 5.5 and Sonnet 5.5 was used for research, RFM framework design, dataset simulation, budget modeling, the discount test simulation, copy drafting and slide drafts.

Data: Duolingo US Digital Twin (simulated), 5,000 learners, snapshot Oct 10, 2026, calibrated to the Q2 2026 letter. No real user data.

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APPENDIX

CINDY SPOTTED DUO.





Got to see first-hand how interactive and global the Duolingo brand and mascot is! The company has truly made itself more than a language learning app—it's also a celebrity.

A fun surprise!

Duolingo's posts about the event:
IG Post | TikTok Post | X Post

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